

Google Wave

Google Wave will be based heavily on HTML5, and will showcase most of its features, including the ability to store data on your hard disk

Developer corner

HTML 5 enables much coolness, as well.

Mr Fancy Pants

Another one of HTML 5's talked-about features is the <canvas> element. It conjures up images of a large, editable area that users can draw on, but that's hardly the case. By itself, the <canvas> element is not much – it needs JavaScript to really get it to do something. And that something could potentially be a Flash-killer, if this demo combination of Twitter, <canvas> and <audio> is anything to go by: <http://9elements.com/io/projects/html5/canvas/>.

Let's try a basic canvas demo for ourselves. It's simple enough to create a blank 200x200 canvas to start scribbling on:

```
<!DOCTYPE html> <!--no more fancy
DOCTYPEES-->
<html>
<head>
<title>Canvas Demo</title>
</head>
<body onload="drawSomething();">
<canvas id="test" width="200"
height="200">
</canvas>
</body>
</html>
```

The drawing part comes from JavaScript. The only shape you can draw directly on a canvas is the rectangle; everything else must be drawn using paths, lines or curves. We won't go into all the possible functions here, but here are some of the basics:

fillRect(x-position, y-position, width, height): for a solid rectangle
strokeRect(x-position, y-position, width, height): for just the outline
clearRect(x-position, y-position, width, height): to delete the area under the rectangle
beginPath(): start drawing a path
closePath(): stop drawing
stroke(): closes the path, and draws the outline
fill(): closes the path, and turns it into a solid shape

Once you've begun a path, you've essentially enabled a pencil (or pen, or marker, if you want), which you can command to do what you want:

moveTo(x, y): move to this point without drawing

lineTo(x, y): draw a line from the current position

This is all we'll use for now. Like any other JavaScript, you can put the code within the <script> tags. Here's what the drawSomething() function looks like:

```
function drawSomething()
{
```

```
//get the canvas
var canvas = document.
getElementById('test');
//now get it for drawing
var board = canvas.
getContext('2d');
//create a filled rectangle
board.fillRect(40,25,50,30);
//draw a random shape
board.beginPath();
board.moveTo(10,10);
board.lineTo(30,15);
board.lineTo(20,50);
board.lineTo(100,150);
board.lineTo(30,150);
board.fill(); //closes the shape
}
```

And here's the result:



The resulting scribbles

This is just to give you an idea of what you can do with canvas; if you're up to it, you can go over to Mozilla's excellent canvas tutorial for more: https://developer.mozilla.org/en/Canvas_tutorial.

There are several other neat features, too, including support for drag-and-drop. You can make any element draggable by simply adding the **draggable="true"** attribute, and then use JavaScript to handle the result of someone actually dragging the element.

Now, make it work

There's a lot more HTML 5 than our page count will permit, but a good question arises at this point: "Will it work in all browsers?" A large portion of the HTML 5 spec is supported by the latest browsers – Firefox 3.5, Safari 4, and Opera 10 beta – so you can actually create a complete HTML 5 site and have it work normally for any visitors who don't use IE. For IE users, you'll have to include the HTML 5 Enabling Script thus:

```
<!--[if IE]>
<script src="http://html5shiv.
googlecode.com/svn/trunk/html5.
js"></script>
<![endif]>-->
```

Or, you could just tell them to stop using IE, and we'll all be happy in our HTML 5-enabled world. ☑

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